

POT & PARRY

ONE-PAGE RULES • FOR SNOOKER PLAYERS

Standard snooker rules apply except for the changes below.

SETUP

Place the six colors on their usual spots and one red midway between the blue and pink spots. Respot every potted ball; the red returns to its starting position.

EQUIPMENT

Use six portable markers, one matching each color, to record ownership under Claims. Place them in a shared pool before play.

PLAYERS

Play with two sides: two individual players or two teams of two. Teammates share one score.

BASIC PLAY

Black is the ball on for the opening stroke. Thereafter, any object ball may be nominated as the ball on.

Normal turns rotate by side. On a team side, teammates alternate its normal turns in a fixed order.

A round contains one normal turn for each side. A team therefore has only one normal visit per round.

CLAIMS

Red cannot be claimed. Each color is either open, with its marker in the pool, or claimed by the side holding its marker. All six colors start open.

Each side may claim up to three colors.

Legally potting an open color scores its value. If the side is below its limit, the striker takes and keeps its marker, claiming the color for the side. Otherwise, the marker remains in the pool and the color remains open. A team owns its markers jointly.

A claimed color scores only for its owner. Other sides score zero for potting it. A claimed yellow or green scores four for its owner; other claimed colors retain their values.

Claims remain after the balls are respotted.

WINNING

The target is exactly 50. When a legal pot reaches it, resolve the pot fully, including any new claim and respot, then end the side's visit immediately. The side may play no further stroke and has a provisional finish until the round ends.

- No further parries may be called that round. Unfinished sides take only their remaining normal turns.
- A provisionally finished side keeps its target score, skips any remaining normal turn and retains its claims.
- At the end of the round, one side on its target wins; multiple sides on their targets use the blue-ball shoot-out.

A legal pot that would exceed the target scores zero but continues the turn and may still create a claim. Potting another side's claimed color also scores zero and continues the turn.

Blue-ball shoot-out

Claims and match scores do not apply. Continue in normal side order; for a team, the teammate next due takes its first attempt, then teammates alternate. Each legal pot scores one shoot-out point. Each tied side takes a direct blue attempt from the D into a declared pocket. The blue may touch only the jaws of that pocket. After equal attempts, eliminate sides below the leading shoot-out score and repeat until one remains.

PARRY

A side may call one parry per normal turn before any stroke, including after a successful pot.

The challenger names another side's claimed color as the challenged color, then nominates any object ball for the setup stroke. Red and the challenged color are both valid setup balls.

The challenger must play a legal setup stroke without a pot. A foul or pot cancels the parry, applies the penalty and ends the challenger's turn.

After a legal setup, the owner plays the challenged color as the ball on in an extra visit. For a team, the teammate next due plays without advancing the teammate order.

The owner may deliberately concede the parry by playing another shot; treat it as a parry foul.

- Legal stroke without a pot: The parry is defended and the color stays claimed.
- Legal pot: The parry is defended; the owner scores and may continue the extra visit. If the owner reaches its target, the visit ends immediately under Winning. Any later foul is ordinary.
- Foul: The owner pays the penalty and returns the challenged color's marker to the pool, making it open. The challenger resumes the interrupted turn from the resulting position.

After a defended parry, including one that reaches the target, the challenger does not resume and normal turn order continues. The extra visit is not a normal turn and cannot contain another parry. The challenger cannot call another after resuming an interrupted turn following a parry foul.

FREE BALL

After a foul, a free ball is available only if the incoming side is snookered on red, every open color and every color it owns. Eligibility ignores the exact target.

The side may nominate another side's claimed color to represent any eligible ball. It scores that ball's value without changing claims. Other free-ball rules apply normally.

FOULS

Foul points are deducted from the offending side. Scores cannot fall below zero. The foul-and-a-miss rule is not used.

OPTIONAL TIMED SHOWDOWN

When time is limited, the sides may agree before the match to use a visible 30-minute clock.

When time expires, complete the current round under the ordinary rules. If nobody wins, record each side's score. Each side then declares a fixed personal target: the next higher multiple of five or the next higher multiple of ten.

Each side also gets a loss line ten points below its recorded score. For example, a side on 33 may choose 35 or 40 and has a loss line of 23.

During the showdown, scores may fall below zero. Reaching or crossing the loss line eliminates that side.

Begin the showdown's first round from the existing position and in normal turn order. Each personal target replaces 50 under Winning. Multiple finishers use the blue-ball shoot-out; the sole remaining side after eliminations wins. Foul penalties change neither targets nor loss lines.